This is related to the problems of knowledge partnerships and the comfort with intellectual discourse. The best policy teams in India are well connected into intellectual capabilities, are comfortable with criticism, and are able to debate with their critics as part of the public discourse. Weak policy teams are more likely to be disconnected from intellectual capabilities, work in secrecy, react in a hostile way to criticism, and deliver poor results in policymaking.

When a policy team is comfortable with articulating and debating a reform in public, and listens to other points of view in order to engage in a process of iterative refinement, this sends a signal to private persons that there is genuine capability in the policy process. This improves the legitimacy of the policy process and increases optimism that good work will be done.

Summing up

> *Good debate to good debate, knowledge grows.*
>
> Ancient Sanskrit proverb

Secrecy harms policy planning and execution.

In a liberal democracy, the relationship between the policymaker and the individual is not the relationship between a ruler and a subject. The policy process is a process of negotiation. The losers from a reform require fair warning. When there is ample warning, the adaptations of the private sector kick in early, and the gains for the economy are obtained in a shorter time.

Confident policymakers work in the open. Working in the open signals capability.

The most harmful events are those where a policy announcement shows up on a website in the evening, without any prior warning, and is effective next morning. The best episodes are those with an open consultative process, where the legal instrument showing up on the website is a non-